with a push past cover and begin to play some strokes. I am batting with Albie Morkel, my good friend, enjoying myself …

Andrew McDonald is running in to bowl his medium pace. I am facing, on 117 not out, feeling confident. I pull the first ball of the over, and it goes for six. I heave at the second ball, and it goes for six. I launch myself into a drive at the third ball, and it soars for six over long-on.

Albie is beaming when we meet in the middle of the pitch.

'Listen,' he says, 'you've got to go for this now. You've got to try to get six sixes in one over.'

'Hold on, Albs,' I reply, 'we're playing Test cricket here, not Twenty20.'

The fourth ball is a little shorter, and I manage to pull it into the crowd at cow corner. That's four sixes from four balls. The crowd is excited, urging me to hit two more sixes and make some history, but it's not meant to be. I charge at the fifth ball, planning to drive it straight, but Andrew sees me coming and bowls a yorker at my feet. I manage to dig out a single past cover point.

Newlands is buzzing and I reach 150 with a full-blooded drive over mid-on. Another boundary, driven through extra cover, takes our score to 623 for seven, South Africa's highest score against Australia. It's becoming a special day. I'm in the zone and everything is going my way.

I am eventually caught on the mid-wicket boundary, out for 163 from 196 balls in just over five hours, including seven sixes and 12 fours. The Cape Town crowd is generous in their appreciation as I head back to the pavilion, but I hear the applause of only one man, the applause of my father. I have scored the ninth Test hundred of my career but it is the first time I've scored a Test century with him in the stadium.

We are eventually bowled out for 651 and, despite Mitchell Johnson's defiant unbeaten century, Paul Harris takes six wickets and guides us to victory by an innings and 20 runs. Our form is maintained when we win both T20 internationals and the ODI series by three matches to two.